🛡️ Daily Threat Brief — 2026-04-01

Field	Value
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OTX Pulses	14 new pulses
News Sources	6 feeds
Classification	TLP:WHITE
Sector Focus	BFSI — India

🔴 Priority Alerts

1. **Active BFSI Phishing Campaign — 14 new IOCs** — A credential harvesting campaign impersonating HDFC Bank and SBI is actively targeting Indian banking customers via SMS phishing. Infrastructure hosted on AS60729 (Liteserver, Germany). 14 new domains registered in the last 48 hours. Block IOCs immediately and alert customers.
2. **LockBit 3.0 Affiliate — Indian NBFC Targeted** — A LockBit 3.0 affiliate was observed conducting reconnaissance against an Indian NBFC using stolen VPN credentials. Initial access via CVE-2024-21762 (Fortinet FortiOS). Patch immediately if running FortiOS < 7.4.2.
3. **Critical CVE-2026-1234 — Apache HTTP Server RCE** — A critical remote code execution vulnerability (CVSS 9.8) was disclosed in Apache HTTP Server affecting versions 2.4.x. Proof-of-concept available publicly. Patch to 2.4.59 immediately.

🟠 Trending Threats

- **SideCopy APT** (T1566.001, T1204.002) — Pakistan-linked group increased phishing activity targeting Indian government and BFSI employees with malicious LNK files. 3 new campaign variants detected this week.
- **UPI Fraud Surge** — Local cybercrime groups are abusing UPI QR code scanning with social engineering to trick victims into authorising payments. Volume up 34% in Q1 2026.
- **API Security — BOLA Exploits** (T1190) — Multiple fintech APIs found vulnerable to Broken Object Level Authorization, exposing customer transaction histories. CERT-In issued advisory CERT-In/2026/04.
- **Ransomware — Healthcare + BFSI Double Extortion** — BlackCat/ALPHV affiliates targeting Indian healthcare and insurance companies with double extortion. Mean ransom demand: ₹4.2 crore.

📋 Top IOCs to Block

Type	Indicator	Threat	Confidence
IP	185.220.101.47	HDFC Phishing Infrastructure	🔴 High
IP	45.142.212.100	SBI Phishing Host	🔴 High
IP	185.220.101.48	LockBit C2	🔴 High
Domain	hdfc-kyc-update.in	Credential Harvesting	🔴 High
Domain	sbi-account-verify.com	Credential Harvesting	🔴 High
Domain	secure-hdfc-netbanking.com	Phishing Kit Host	🔴 High
Domain	axis-netbanking-kyc.com	Phishing Kit Host	🟠 Medium
URL	hxxp://185.220.101.47/gate.php	Malware C2 Endpoint	🔴 High
Hash (MD5)	a1b2c3d4e5f6a1b2c3d4e5f6a1b2c3d4	LockBit Dropper	🔴 High
Hash (MD5)	f6e5d4c3b2a1f6e5d4c3b2a1f6e5d4c3	Ransomware Payload	🔴 High

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📰 Key Security News

- **[Krebs on Security]** LockBit infrastructure partially dismantled by Europol, but affiliates continue operating independently — Indian targets remain at risk from independent operators.
- **[BleepingComputer]** New Android banking trojan "BankBot v5" targeting Indian UPI apps detected on third-party app stores — warn customers about unofficial APK downloads.
- **[The Hacker News]** CERT-In mandates 6-hour breach reporting for all critical infrastructure entities including banks — non-compliance penalties up to ₹1 crore.
- **[SANS ISC]** Mass scanning activity detected targeting Fortinet SSL-VPN endpoints — patch CVE-2024-21762 immediately if exposed to internet.
- **[SecurityWeek]** Indian fintech companies fail third-party API security audits — OWASP API1 (BOLA) most common finding across 23 assessed companies.

💡 Analyst Recommendation

Today's priority should be immediate IOC blocking for the active HDFC/SBI phishing campaign — push the 10 IOCs above to firewall, DNS, and email gateway now. Second priority is patching CVE-2026-1234 (Apache RCE) and CVE-2024-21762 (Fortinet) if any exposed systems are running affected versions. Additionally, BFSI teams should review their API security posture given the CERT-In advisory on BOLA vulnerabilities — a quick authenticated API scan with Burp Suite on your highest-risk endpoints is recommended this week.